

Raptor Center Announces Appointment Of New President/CEO

The Carolina Raptor Center has hired Joy Braunstein to be the non-profit organization's new president and chief executive office. Braunstein was appointed to her new position in September 2008. The Carolina Raptor Center (CRC) is dedicated to environmental education and the conservation of birds of prey through public education, the rehabilitation of injured and orphaned raptors, and research.

Throughout her career Ms. Braunstein has focused on environmental advocacy and awareness, has published papers highlighting the connections between environmental policies and human security, and has built a large national and international network.

As an environmental protection specialist with the U.S. Department of the Interior, she handled varied program analysis, evaluation, and planning responsibilities. As a member of the leadership team for the United Jewish Federation in Pittsburgh, Braunstein managed the federation's planning and funding programs, including a number of environmental and overseas grants.

One of the first grants managed by Braunstein was "Birds With No Borders," in which at-risk Israeli and Arab youth were taught about the migratory birds that ignore the artificial boundaries created as countries and territories. The program used the birds as lessons in sharing and tolerance, while teaching the children about science.

The University of Pittsburgh tapped Braunstein as adjunct faculty to develop and teach courses in public policy and

courses in law and the environment. She holds undergraduate degrees in Environmental Education and Environmental Policy from Unity College in Maine and Johnson State College in Vermont; a Master of Environmental Law from Vermont Law School; and a Master of Public Administration from the University of Pittsburgh's Graduate School of Public and International Affairs.

"Carolina Raptor Center has a strong education and conservation philosophy," says Braunstein. "At a time when the population is re-thinking important environmental issues, we can increase our significance as a premier regional environmental organization while becoming a

nationally significant organization with an international presence."

The CRC was founded in 1979. More than 12,000 injured and orphaned raptors have come to CRC since its inception, and last year more than 63% of birds that survived the first 24 hours were released back into the wild. More than 100 non-releasable raptors, whose injuries make it impossible to survive in the wild, are permanent residents of CRC and educate the public. Last year outreach exhibitions taught more than 100,000 people about raptors and their importance to the environment, CRC's "Wild Wings" educated more than 36,000 children in Carolina communities, and more than 32,000 people visited CRC. The center is supported by grants and contributions. Find more information on their website at www.carolinaraptorcenter.org or call 704-875-6521.



Joy Braunstein, the new president/CEO of the Carolina Raptor Center